

Fact, Fiction or Fake?

Check before you share



BIG IDEA False or misleading posts spread fast because people pass them on. A few quick checks before you share can stop them. If something harmful is going around, tell an adult and report it in the app.

1 HOOK 2'

2 ACTIVITY 8'

3 DISCUSS 3'

4 TAKEAWAY 2'

REVIEW STATUS Educator review before use. Made-up claims only. A teacher, librarian or media specialist should read it once. Check district policy on political or news content [VERIFY].

COUNSELOR HEADS-UP FIRST + OPT-OUT PLAN A short heads-up is recommended: a student may disclose being targeted by a rumor. No formal opt-out is expected; district policy governs [VERIFY].

1 HOOK 2 MIN *60-second script* Hackles up? When a post makes you mad, scared or in a hurry to share, notice that feeling. “Share this now!” is a sign to pause. “Quick game. I whisper a made-up sentence to the first person in each row: ‘The cafeteria is giving out free pizza coupons if you tap the link.’ Pass it quietly; then we compare the last version with the first. (*It changed.*) Online, messages change too, reach far more people, faster, and often nobody checks. That is misinformation: false or misleading information, sometimes shared by people who mean no harm.”

2 ACTIVITY 8 MIN *Claim Check*

- 1 (1 min) Read CF-P3.** Tavi, twelve, sees “SCHOOL CLOSED TOMORROW because of a danger. Tell everyone!” with a scary photo. Friends are forwarding it. Tavi’s thumb hovers over “share.” Write the Check Strip: **WHO** made it? **PROOF?** **WHO ELSE** says so? **FEELING:** is it trying to scare, anger or rush me?
- 2 (4 min) Claim Check.** Each group takes three made-up Claim Cards (a closing rumor, a miracle cure, a “private message” screenshot, a confident chatbot answer, a chart whose bars start at 90, an old flood photo “from today”). Name the first question and a decision: SHARE, CHECK FIRST, DO NOT SHARE or TELL AN ADULT.
- 3 (2 min) Debrief by card** with the Answer Key. Redraw the chart from zero.
- 4 (1 min) Share Pause rule:** “If I cannot say who made it and who else says so, I do not pass it on.” Rumors about a person, or asks for money: report it and tell an adult.

DIFFERENTIATE Two Claim Cards, sentence starters (“I would check ___ because ___”), the Check Strip as a labeled card.

FAMILY CARD Try the four questions on one post together. If a post is hurting someone or asking for money or personal information, report it and tell a trusted adult.

PREP IN 5 MINUTES

Materials: RP3 Forward Chain slips (six per row), Claim Cards (six per class; each group works three), Check Strip per student.

- ☐ Write one made-up message on each chain slip.
- ☐ Split the six Claim Cards so groups cover all six.

3 DISCUSS 3 MIN

- 1** “Why do false posts spread faster when they make us angry or scared?”
- 2** “Why might someone with good intentions share something false?”
- 3** “What can you do if a friend shares something false?” (A private message, never a pile-on.)

4 TAKEAWAY 2 MIN “Pause before you share. Check who made it, the proof and who else says so. Tell an adult if it is hurting someone. It is never your fault if you shared something false by mistake. Fix it by telling people and not passing it on.”

Hand signal: Hackles Up (hand brushed up the neck, optional), then Pause, Check, Tell. Post it: “Who made it? What is the proof? Who else says so?”

EXIT TICKET “Write one Check Strip question you will ask before sharing and one person you could check with.”

FUN BOOST Fact Detective Relay. Each group has 60 seconds per card to name the first question and the decision. Thumbs-up for a good reason, not for speed.

LEVEL-UP Family Four Questions. Try the Check Strip questions on one post with a parent or caregiver; bring one sentence.

IF A STUDENT TELLS YOU SOMETHING

- **Say:** “Thank you for telling me. You did the right thing.”
- “This is not your fault, and you are not in trouble.”
- “I can’t keep this secret. I need to bring in people who can help, and I will tell you who.”
- **Do not say:** “Why did you share it?” or “Are you sure?”
- “I won’t tell anyone.”
- Asking to see messages, photos or accounts.

First 10 Minutes: see the Disclosure Guide.

Then: tell your counselor or designated person right away. Follow your school policy and your state’s reporting law.